

Colour is an inherited value. Therefore, specifying the colour blue on a containing div will result in all contained text (including headings, lists, block quotes, and so on) being blue, unless the specified element is given a different value.

5.1.3 Background colour

The background-color property is used to set the background colour of an HTML element. It is the fastest way of transforming your site from plain black text on a white background into something more engaging. This property is something you will use very frequently. Again, it is recommended that if you decide to give your web site a solid-coloured background, use a web-safe colour. This will guarantee that the colour will not turn out wrong when it displays on other computer platforms.

Just like a highlighter pen, CSS uses background-color property to colour the background of the text. In the following example, a yellow background-color is declared alongside black text:

```
p {  
  color:#000;  
  background-color:#FF0;  
  line-height:150%  
}
```

A custom `<span>` element can be used to control a section of the paragraph, rather than the whole chunk. This method demands additional markup, but it is the only way to affect a designated portion of text contained within a paragraph,

Content is King

This is a paragraph. Nothing particularly special about it, but the visitor is going to read it anyway, so it may as well say something useful.

Background Colour is applied to the highlighted text

unless you target text already defined with phrase elements such as `<strong>` or `<em>`. Rather than assign the background colour to the whole paragraph, a class is created that will be used to cloak the text that needs a highlight. In the following CSS, background-color is removed from the paragraph selector, and a new class called highlight is defined: